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Written By Mike Bannerman

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The Tools Space Adventure

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By Mike Bannerman

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It was a clear, starry night in Twin Falls and the whole sky was twinkling! Roxie had set up her brand new space telescope and was gazing at the stars, the planets and the faraway galaxies. The Moon looked so big, bright and close! If only the Tools could go to space one day — now THAT would be cool!



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Diesel always had a secret project hiding somewhere at the back of his garage — and this one was the biggest yet! A ROCKET! A real one!
It was a little bit wonky, and quite a few of the bolts looked rather loose. "It'll be FINE!" said Diesel.
Hector Hammer and JJ the Jackhammer couldn't believe their eyes.



Diesel then managed to convince them to test drive the rocket!

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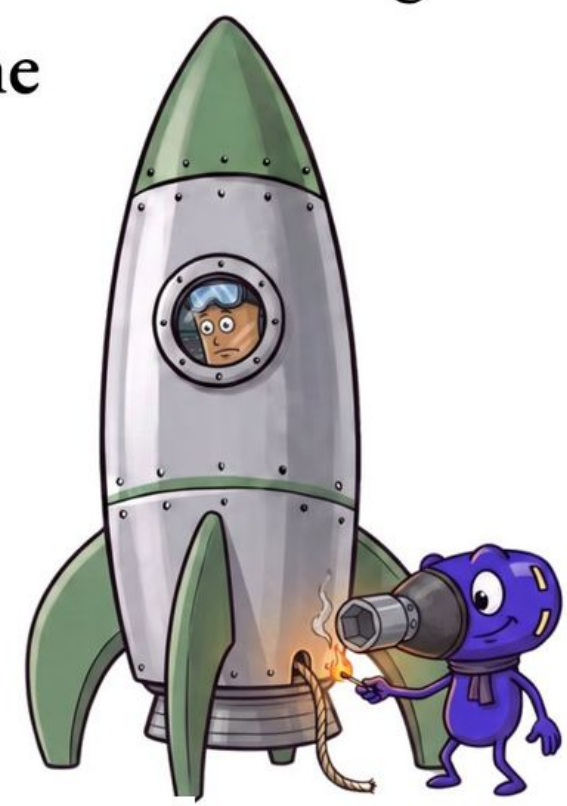
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Hector and JJ squeezed into the rocket. Floyd the Firehose shook his head — this looked VERY dangerous! But before he could say a single word, Diesel had already lit the fuse. 3... 2... 1...

BLAST OFF!

Up, up and away went the rocket — rattling and wobbling all the way into the night sky!



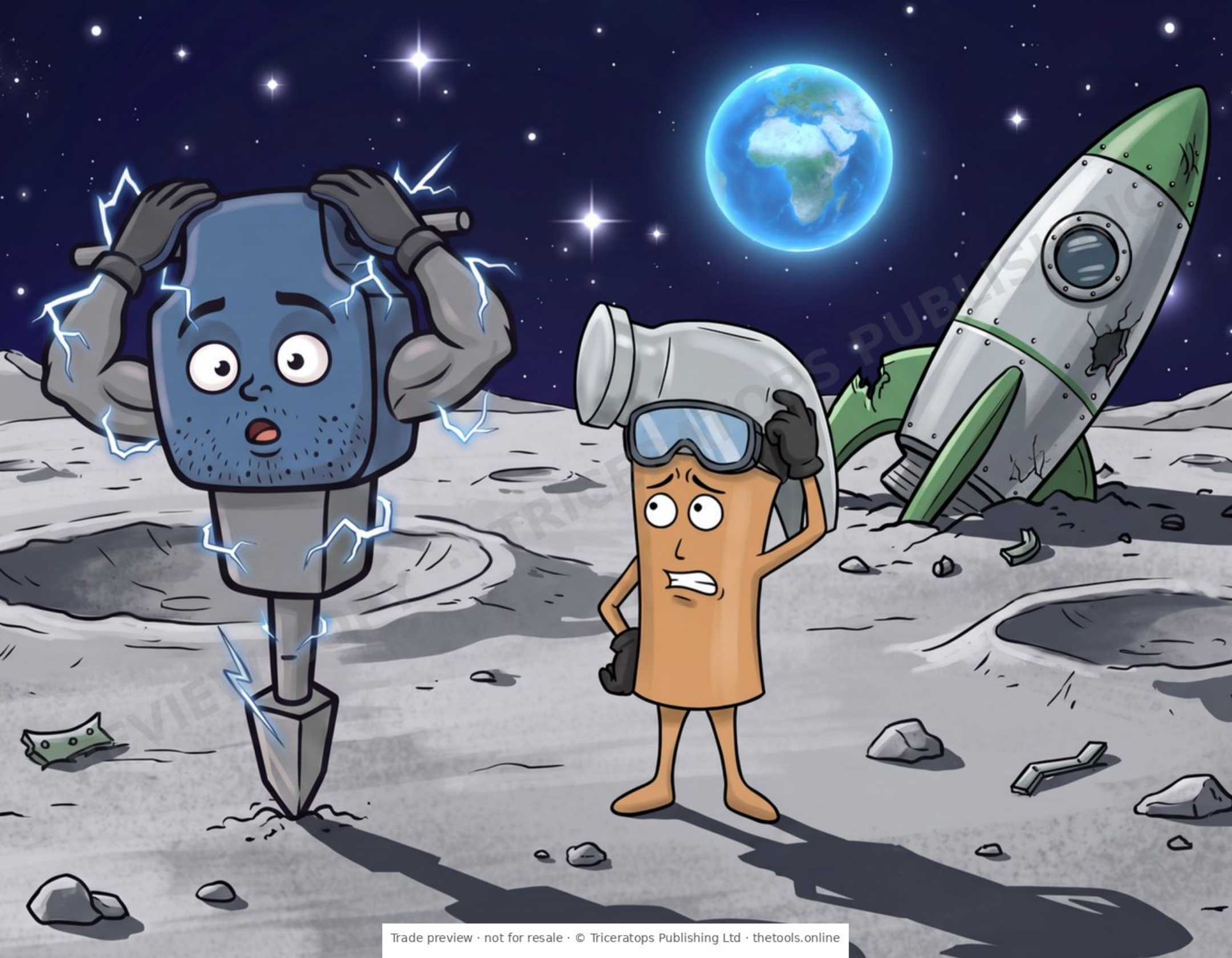


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The rocket landed on the Moon — then it spluttered, clunked and broke down completely! Bits started dropping off everywhere! A bolt here. A panel there. Hector climbed out, dusted himself down and switched on his space radio.

"Hector to Twin Falls! Diesel — your rocket is NO GOOD!"

"We're stuck on the Moon!" Somebody needed to come and rescue them — and fast!



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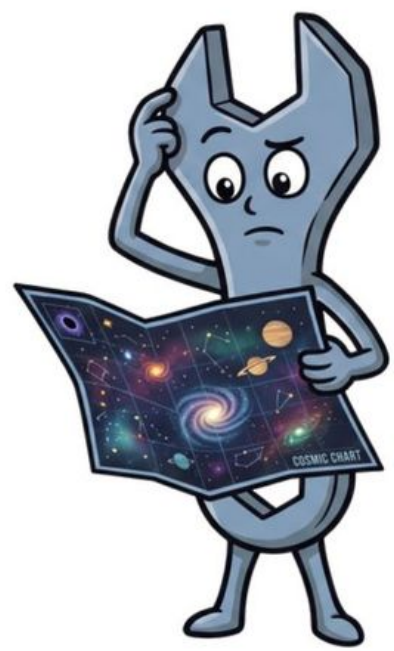
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Back in Twin Falls, the crew got
to work on their biggest build yet!
A spaceship good enough to fly
right across the solar system!





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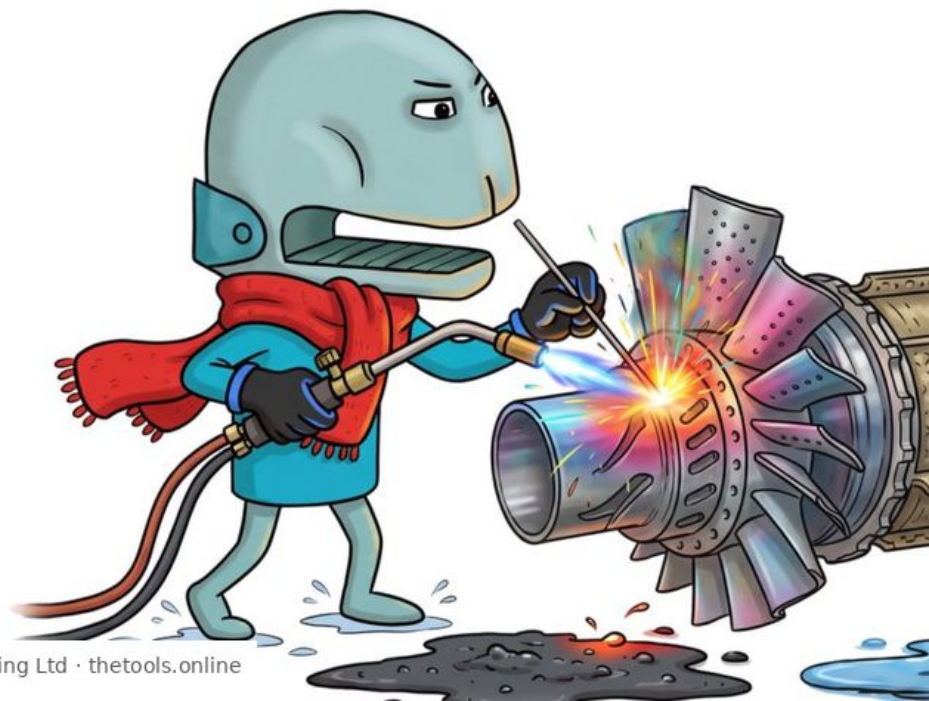
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This is a build that would take most people years — but not the Tools!





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At last, the Tools' spaceship was ready for launch! It was the biggest, most brilliant thing they had ever built! Diesel jumped straight into the driver's seat — and grabbed the map too. Not the best idea.

Sam worked the computer screens. Paz and Roxie buckled up tight... 3... 2... 1... BLAST OFF!



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Faster and faster they zoomed, until a small grey planet appeared — the closest planet to the enormous, blazing Sun! Diesel cheered. The Moon! They'd made it!
But Roxie switched on her little projector, and a picture of the planet popped up in the air.
It wasn't the Moon at all — it was Mercury!



They had gone completely the wrong way! Turn back — QUICK!

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They turned around, and soon they were flying past a planet wrapped in thick, pale yellow clouds. Roxie's projector lit up again — Venus!

It was almost the same size as Earth, but nobody would ever want to land there. Underneath all those clouds, Venus is extremely hot — the hottest planet of all!



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And then — there it was! A beautiful blue and green planet, glowing in the dark.

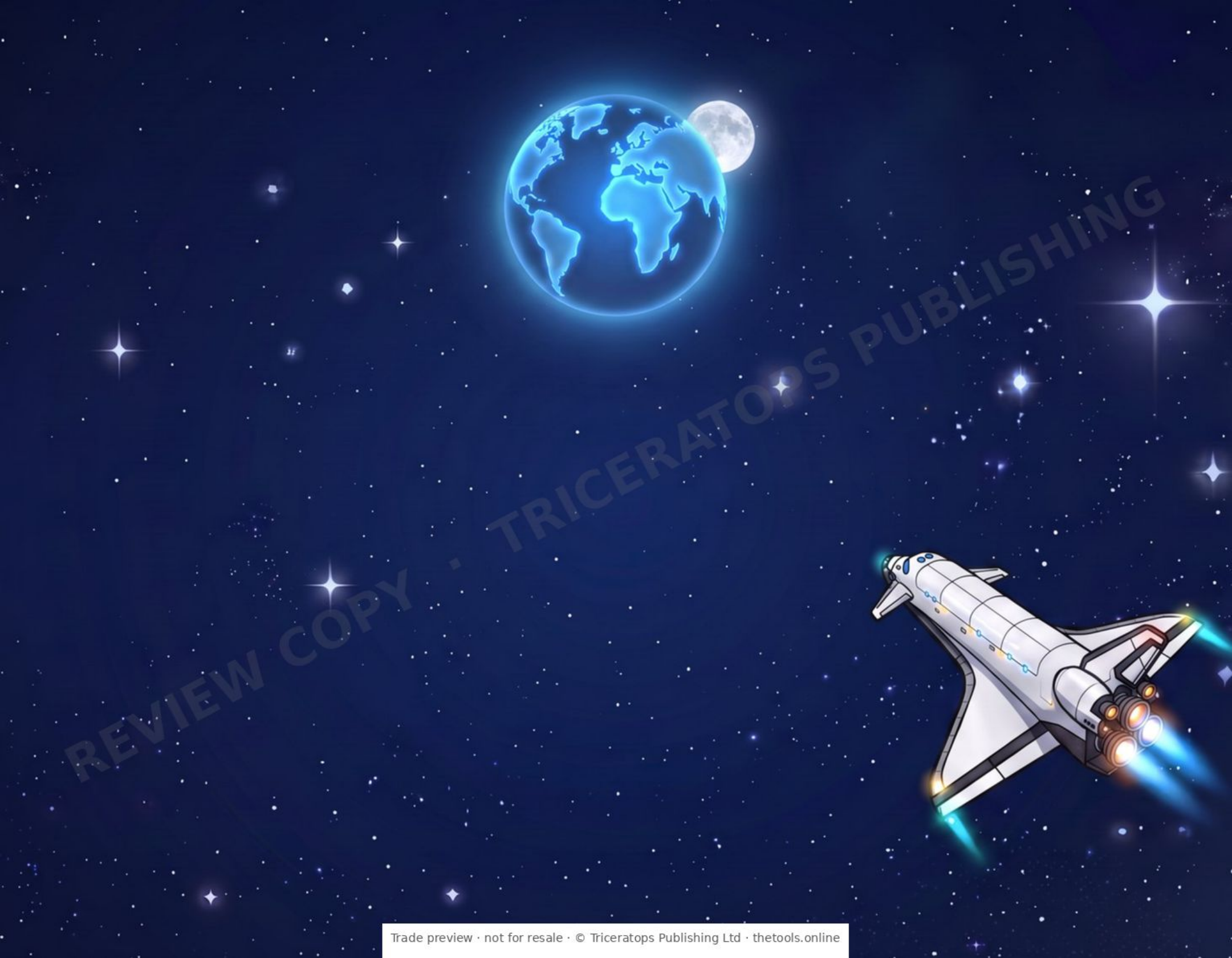
HOME! Paz pressed his face against the window and waved.

The Moon had to be around here somewhere... but Diesel didn't look up from the map. Past Earth they zoomed — and kept on going! Oh Diesel!



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Up ahead was another planet. Diesel cheered — there was the Moon! It just looked a bit... red.

Roxie checked her projector. It wasn't the Moon. It was Mars, the Red Planet!

They had gone right past the Moon! Still, Mars had rocky ground they could land on — so down they went for a closer look.



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Down they came — BUMP — onto the red, dusty ground!

Sam picked up a Mars rock and studied it. Paz and Roxie jumped into some space buggies and raced each other round the rocks, sending red dust flying everywhere!

Meanwhile Diesel stared at the map — he was very confused. Was there anybody on Mars they could ask for directions? Sam shook his head.



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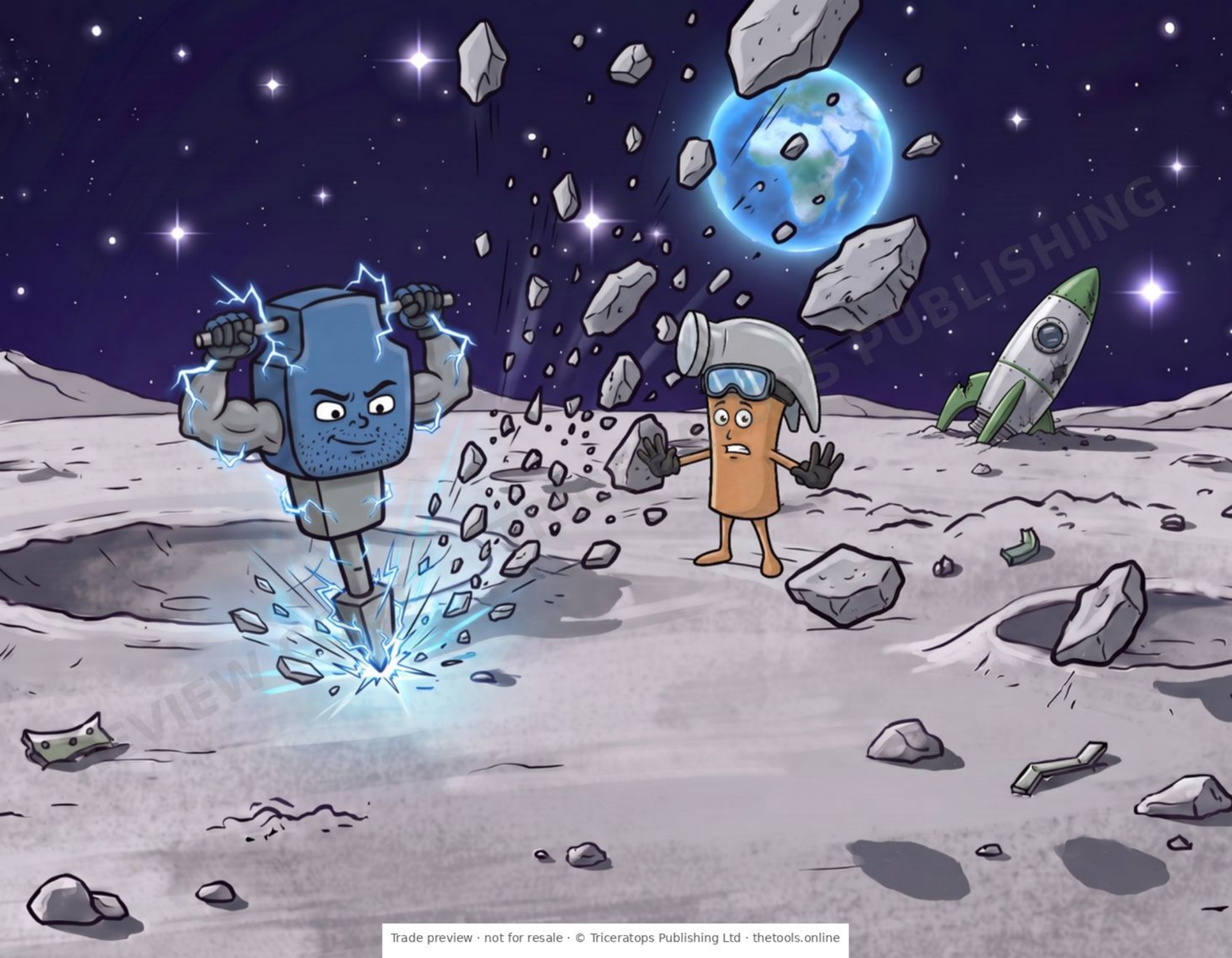
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Back into space they went — straight towards an ENORMOUS planet with swirly stripes! Jupiter, the biggest planet in the solar system!
It was made of gas, so there was nowhere to land. And that big red spot? That was a giant storm — bigger than the whole Earth! "Stay well away from THAT!" Sam said nervously.
For once, Diesel listened, and they zoomed off quickly.



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Meanwhile, on the Moon, JJ was doing what he does best... smashing!

"Would you PLEASE stop drilling the Moon?" shouted Hector.

JJ held up a lump of moon rock. He loves collecting rocks and stones.



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Further and further they flew, until a planet with the most beautiful rings came into view.
Saturn! Paz was excited — it was his favourite planet in the whole solar system!
The rings were made of chunks of ice and rock. It was AMAZING!



But Sam was getting worried. Surely the Moon wasn't THIS far away?
Diesel kept looking at the map, not really knowing what he was looking for.

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Next came Uranus — a pale blue-green planet, spinning on its side with its rings standing up tall! What a cool colour!

Roxie's projector told them all about it.

Uranus was one of the two ice giants — freezing cold, with no solid ground to land on. Paz shivered just looking at it.





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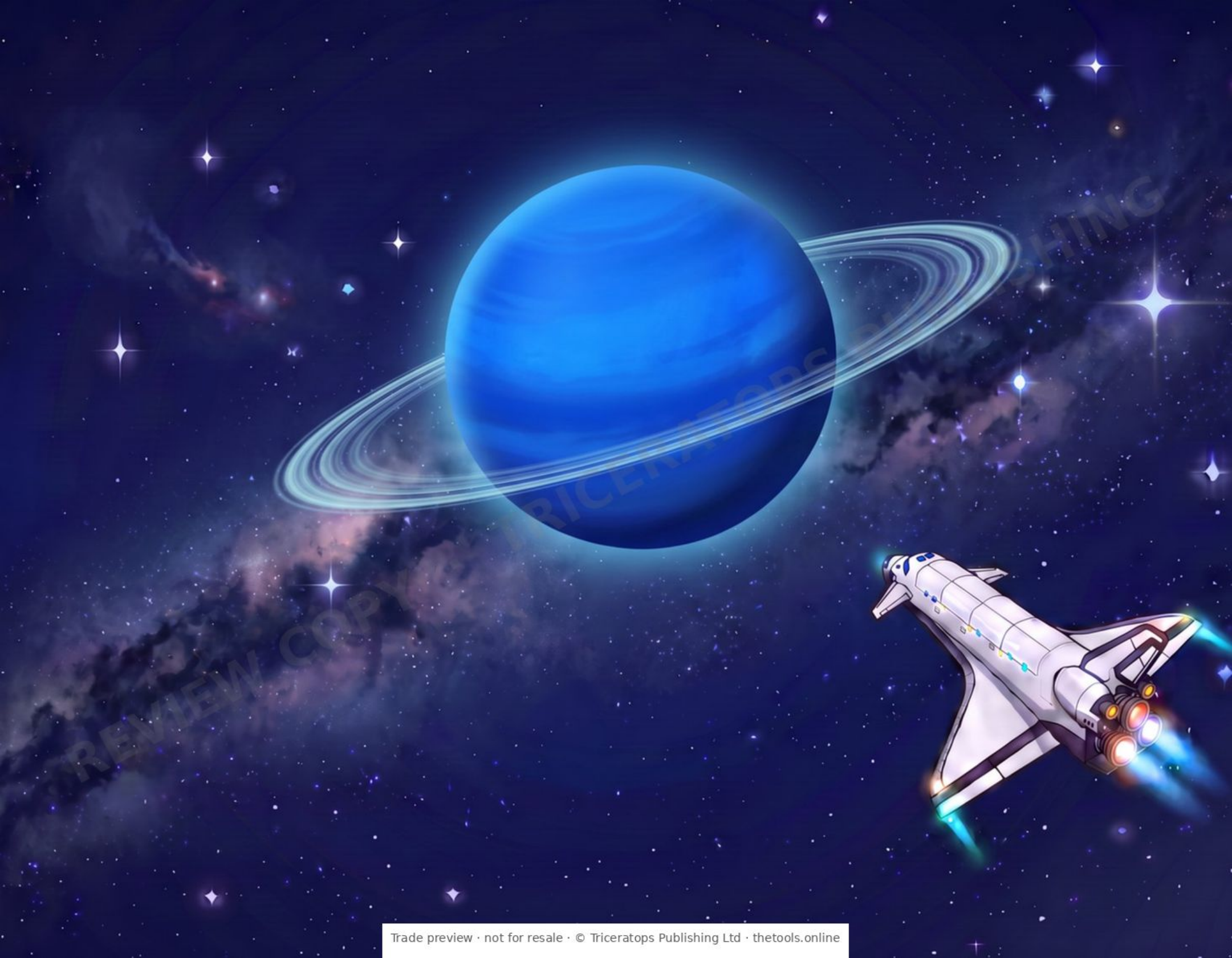
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Then came Neptune, the other ice giant — a deep, beautiful blue, and also very, very cold!
The windows began to frost over.
Everybody looked at each other.
They had come far, far, FAR too far. It was time to turn back!



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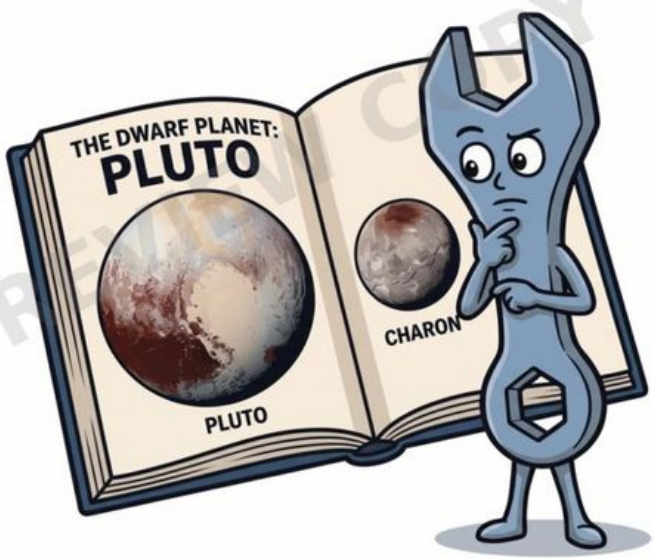
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Next stop, Pluto — the very last planet! Or so Diesel thought. Sam opened his space book and shook his head. Pluto used to be called a planet — but nowadays it's called a dwarf planet.



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Then Sam very carefully took the map off Diesel, and read it properly.
At last, the Tools were heading the right way! After a very long time, travelling very, VERY fast, they finally spotted the Moon.



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The spaceship landed gently on the Moon, and out bounced the Tools! Hector and JJ had never been so happy to see anyone in their whole lives!

Paz floated around in the low gravity, doing somersaults and flips.

Now for the ride home! Hector folded his arms.

"What took you so long?"

Diesel grinned.

"We took the scenic route!"

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THE END

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Found the secret word?

Somewhere in this book is a secret word. Only those who have read every page will find it!

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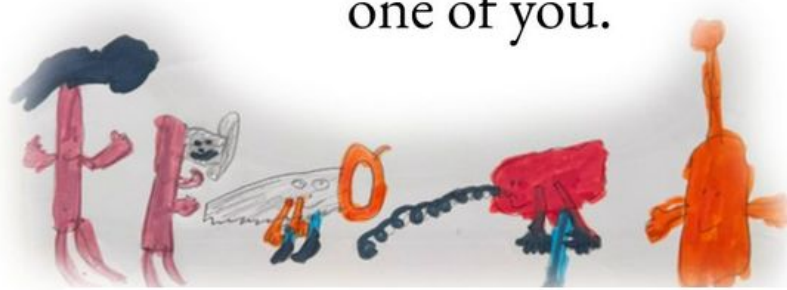
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The idea of The Tools came to me when I was 7 years old. I was doodling on a piece of paper and drew a saw with a face and arms and legs. Soon, more tool characters were created and my mum, dad and close family would always encourage me to make something of it.

Years later, I used the same idea and stories and created these children's books. With a Christian upbringing, I've always had a strong relationship with God and I truly believe He blesses us with ideas and things we might not even think to use. So for every idea or story that I write or have written, to God be the glory. Please find the inspirational Bible quote at the back of each of my books and may God bless each and every one of you.







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" The Lord bless you and keep you:
The Lord make his face to shine
upon you, and be gracious to you. "

Numbers 6:24–25

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